

SURRENDER

My beloved friends, the light of the Eternal streams as a great blessing to all of you, to all your endeavors that are sanctified by your commitment to serve God and His magnificent evolutionary plan.

The hand of God can be recognized in many earthly manifestations. His presence can be keenly felt -- and so can it be felt when His presence is being blocked out by man turning away from Him who is always present. One of the earthly manifestations in which God's works, divine creativity, the eternal spirit, can always be seen, is nature. In nature you cannot help but marvel at the wisdom and foresight manifest of every smallest detail to protect, sustain and maintain every species. The abundance with which all created entities are being provided for, the beauty, the richness, speak clearly and eloquently that only the greatest of all imaginable minds could have devised the many systems that maintain life on earth.

It also has become clear to many human beings that the balance is being disturbed through thoughtless or greedy dispositions. More awareness has grown in this regard in recent times, and this is important, of course.

But there is also an aspect in nature that seems contradictory to divine love; an aspect that seems, in fact cruel. There exist destructive forces -- storms, floods, earthquakes. But when seen from another angle, you will recognize that these manifestations are nothing but the necessary crises every entity must go through in its process to reestablish inner harmony with divine law.

There is another manifestation in nature fall into a different category. It is the fact that one species of animal can often only maintain its life at the expense of another species. Thus you have predators and victims. Although the victims are always equipped with the best measures of defense so as to give them what you may call a "sporting chance," on the whole, one species often serves the maintenance of the other. And all of these various conditions contribute to maintain an overall balance. This manifestation of one animal killing another for its nourishment may appear a cruel measure and appears to deny God's presence in this regard. Although animals can never indulge in the useless cruelty and destructiveness that human beings are capable of (precisely due to man's higher evolved consciousness that can always channel itself into either direction of good or evil), it does seem -- and in a sense, is -- tragic that an animal needs to endure panic and pain in order to serve the total life process.

Now I want you to understand that this manifestation reflects precisely humanity's overall state of consciousness, which is dualistic. It is a combination of good and evil. Man's belief system contains always this polarity. Since his total belief system creates the environment, the earth sphere reflects exactly this polarity. It can be observed in the most remote manifestations that on the

surface appear to have nothing whatever to do with man's state of consciousness. They seem givens, independently created from man's beliefs, attitudes, feelings, and intentionalities. But this is never so. Every existing sphere, realm or world, from the lowest to the highest, is always and totally a reflection of the overall state of consciousness of the beings who have congregated together. It has often been said that heaven and hell are nothing else but states of consciousness. This is true in one sense, only it is often overlooked by those who make this statement that states of consciousness create realities, surroundings, environments, conditions.

If this world reflects the combination of the two polarities, there must also exist other worlds in which one side so overweighs the other that actually polarities no longer exist. Spheres of evil (hell) would therefore only manifest pain, fear and suffering and no beauty at all, while spheres of good do not know any pain, fear, and suffering. Imagine a world in which the tiger and the deer lovingly befriend each other! No animal needs the life of another to sustain its own life.

Art sometimes reflects this blissful world because the soul deeply knows it and longs to return to it. Thus painters, musicians, poets, dancers give out a small measure of this complete world of bliss in which nothing ever dies or wilts; in which life gloriously finds forever new expressions without any break in consciousness that blots out the continuity of life. Those of you who are ready for or are closer to this state of consciousness will experience such artistic expressions, or the beautiful expressions of nature, as intensely healing and soothing, as encouraging and as incredibly desirable. But for those who are still deeply submerged in the darkness, such divine reminders and expressions are as painful as they are nourishing for the more enlightened spirit. This is why there is no light, no truth, no love, no divine reminder in the spheres of hell. It cannot be borne. The entities need to gradually grow into more evolved states until such light can become further measures that make further growth possible.

I am saying all this to you to make you realize once again that you inhabit an in-between sphere in which neither polarity excludes the other, reflecting exactly your own state of mind. Perhaps you can best understand the state that cannot bear the light when you think of certain discomforts you may occasionally experience when you are in the midst of fullness, of love, light and bliss. On the other hand, negativities, dissension, destruction give you at times a certain negative pleasure and excitement. For beings in the lowest, darkest states of consciousness (or worlds) all light is unbearably painful.

Now, why am I telling you this at this time? The emphasis on the coming work is clearly, as you could see from the last lecture, on overcoming, on transcending; but perhaps first it is on thoroughly understanding duality. For this you must recognize that your present sphere of life and consciousness can only be a combination of what must also exist in other combinations, in different distributions on the scale. And if such variables exist at all, as must be reasonable to assume, then spheres of consciousness must also exist in which there is no duality -- either in the positive or the negative sense. When consciousness first meets the void, the darkness is so great that a negative unity temporarily comes about. Only as consciousness gradually expands, does the other polarity appear on the horizon and thus creates a duality. In that phase duality is already a movement in the evolutionary plan. Only when consciousness completes itself to its total potential does the unity become totally "positive." That is, there is no longer pain, no longer strain, no longer the dying of life, be it ever so temporary, and no longer conflict.

It is my task now to hand you more and more tools to comprehend and overcome duality, to see the pitfalls and mental difficulties that assail the human mind in its present state. Duality always spells conflict and strain, in one way or another. In the last lecture I expounded on one very specific aspect of this. In this lecture I shall broach another topic that is extremely important for all of you and that, at the same time, when fully grasped, will aid you further in overcoming another aspect of duality, of the ever present, so painful polarity in which you constantly battle.

You often use the word surrender. You sense that in this word is contained an important aspect of spiritual completion. Yet there is also a great deal of confusion attached to this word which needs to be explored. A human being who is incapable of surrendering cannot find his core. He cannot find his divine nature. He cannot love. He cannot truly learn and grow. Such an individual is a very stiff, defended and closed up structure. The ability to surrender is an essential inner movement from which all that is good can flow.

You need to surrender to the will of God. Otherwise you will always remain attached to the very shortsighted and the much pain- and confusion- producing self-will. Surrender means a letting go of self, of cherished ideas, goals, desires, opinions -- all for the sake of truth. For God is truth.

You also need to surrender to your own feelings. If you do not, you will always impoverish yourself and shut out your feeling nature. You become an automaton. You need to surrender to those whom you love. This means trusting; giving the benefit of the doubt; being willing to yield if this serves the cause of the truth. You surely need to surrender to a teacher in any field you wish to learn. If this basic surrender is lacking, no matter how much the teacher would have to give you, you could receive little, if anything. This must apply of course every bit as much to a spiritual teacher. If you constantly withhold with distrust and reservations, a most important dynamic cannot develop. You may assume that you could possibly absorb mental knowledge from a teacher you inwardly keep aloof from. And this is true up to a degree. But in true learning much more than the outer mental processes are involved. There is an inner, emotional, spiritual, involuntary level which must learn too. And on this level nothing can be absorbed unless a surrender to the teacher exists. This applies to the most mundane things you wish to learn. An accomplishment that exists merely as a mental deduction is not truly absorbed. It must become an inner reality in order to become your own. How much more is this true, of course, about spiritual growth.

The refusal to surrender has to do with lack of trust, with suspicion, with fear, with the misunderstanding that if you surrender you lose your autonomy and your ability to make future decisions. The refusal to surrender creates an over-developed self-will, which takes its toll on the personality. The personality becomes truly impoverished. For the ability to surrender is such a movement of fullness, of giving over, of letting go, that enrichment must follow as a natural law. The over-developed self-will always brings strife. You can see in your world that two self-wills clashing create war on a small or a big scale. If peace is to be made possible -- again between individuals or countries -- a giving in, a yielding must occur.

Yet we cannot simply state that surrender is the key. It is never as simple as that. Should you surrender to a person who is truly untrustworthy? Should you give in in a situation that requires a fighting spirit in order to be in truth? The need to stand up and fight for a good cause, to defend a right position, to assert justified claims is indispensable in a productive, healthy life. The need to discriminate when to trust and when not to trust is also indispensable. And how are you to know

this, you often ask yourself. Confusion arises right here to a very great extent. There are few areas in human life where there is as much displacement, false surrender, and false assertion as is the case here. So how do you become more aware of how to go about this so important aspect of living? How can you avoid capitulation and resignation in the misunderstanding that you are surrendering? How can you avoid a false and stiff holding in when surrender would be appropriate? Let us discuss a few important keys that will eventually enable you to find the fine balance.

It is quite impossible for an ego that is dependent and denies self-responsibility to surrender, because, in such a case, surrender becomes a giving away of autonomy. This is why those who are secretly, often unconsciously, most dependent; why those who crave most for a "perfect" authority to take over are also the most defended against all yielding. They vaguely sense that giving away of self can only occur when the self is strong and healthy because then the self grows even stronger and healthier when it goes through the act of giving itself away. So, my friends, I say to you when you find in yourself or others an inability to surrender, to trust, to give over, to yield, look for the under-current of dependency and denial of genuine self-responsibility. The more rebellion, the greater the show, "I must protect my autonomy, so I will never be told;" the more desperate is the inner wish to not govern his or her own life, to not be made responsible for decisions and their outcome.

When you choose a mate, a friend, a teacher, someone where trust and at least some degree of surrender is necessary; how often are you blinded by wishful thinking and by the self-will that demands the other person to be a certain way in order to accommodate your distorted desires and aims? Since a part of you knows this, the distrust is, to a certain degree, justified, even if the person happens to deserve the trust on realistic terms. In other words, in order to trust and give over, you need to be free, at least to a considerable degree, of unrealistic expectations from the other person. Your gaze has to be clear and unpolluted by childish or destructive motivations. When this is the case, your intuition will function; your observations will be clear and reliable; your channel will come through. You will know that the person to trust does not need ultimate perfection in order to warrant your trust. You will simply be able to yield where this is so necessary.

Surrender never means that you give away forever your ability to adjudge, to make independent decisions, to perhaps even change your course if that is appropriate. For life is in constant flux. Everything and everyone changes. There is no fixed guarantee that what is right today will be so tomorrow. The greater your ability to surrender in the right way, the stronger you find yourself becoming and the clearer your visions are.

In the present state, many of you find yourselves in an interim stage in which the self is not yet complete and whole enough, vision is not objective enough to truly let go into a surrendering position. Yet without this inner attitude, it is quite impossible to become this whole person. It is therefore imperative that you very consciously attempt to further self-responsibility in every possible way -- overt and subtle, inner and outer. And, at the same time, it is imperative that you equally consciously and deliberately pray for being able to trust those who deserve your trust, to follow their leadership and to surrender self-will. This surrender of self-will is always an act toward God, for His will alone must replace your self-will. But sometimes His will can function only through others before it can manifest directly through you. It is God's will that you also surrender to the spiritual leadership He has guided you to. It is God's will that you surrender to some of the most beautiful involuntary processes within yourself, for instance, your love feelings, your deepest intuitions. It is

God's will that you become capable of yielding, as it is His will that you become capable of fighting and standing firm.

As you grow in true autonomy and self-creating, you will sense very clearly that there is no contradiction, no duality in regard to surrender and standing firm. In fact, it will be clear to you that one presupposes the other, that one is not possible without the other.

There is a tragedy in man's struggle. He longs so deeply for a fulfillment that is indeed possible, that is not, as he sometimes suspects, unrealistic. Yet he makes the fulfillment of this longing impossible by blocking the soul's natural inclination toward surrender. All truly good things can only come when you surrender to the greater forces of the universe, within and without; to the Creator; to another human being; to being a follower.

Yet you also need to fight for these fulfillments by relinquishing your claim of passivity, of irresponsibility, of allowing an "ideal" authority to do it all for you. You need active, positive aggression to never, never allow the dark forces within you to conquer you; to make you believe that it is all futile; to make you to give in to their whispering hopelessness and false surrender into your inner ears. You must stand firm and realize the power imbedded in your thought processes, in your inner will, in your ability to choose faith over fear, courage over cowardice. For what requires more courage than belief in God's truth and your power to live and demonstrate it!

There is a finely calibrated balance in regard to active movement of the personality -- be it in action, be it in thought, be it in attitude -- and genuine surrender and giving over. Genuine surrender never weakens the personality. It makes the ego healthier and stronger in a positive sense. It enables you to be more autonomous and active. Similarly, genuine positive activity and self-affirmation renders you sufficiently strong and resilient that you cannot be afraid of letting go of self, of giving over, of allowing to flow with a new movement stemming from sources that are as yet unknown. These forces, as I mentioned before, may come from within you or may mean for you to risk following a teacher or loving a mate. This never means closing your eyes to reality. Quite the contrary, you should always open all your faculties and observe in truth, without your personal motivations to see either better or worse. You may want to see the other person as more perfect because you still wish to abdicate self-responsibility, or because you can then justifiably be disappointed and prove that you need to be always armored against any kind of yielding, following, or movement of surrender. You may wish to see the other person as worse for the same reason. You can then say, "No one should be trusted, I must always be on guard."

You all have surrendered in some areas to some extent. Without this, you would not experience whatever fulfillment and positive states you enjoy. Whatever growth you have experienced on this path was due to a considerable extent because you allowed yourself to trust, at least in part, this process, your helper, your leaders, me. All of this has helped you to open up a little further and give to God the trust you need to have. This trust may not yet be complete. It may not encompass all areas of your being. But to whatever degree it does exist, you are liberated, free, strong and self-confident. What I am saying here sounds indeed like a great paradox. Only when you give yourself over, can you find your real strength and autonomy.

It is equally correct to state that all of you still withhold a part of yourself from this movement of completely giving over. There always remains a little corner of your soul that you hold in reserve,

that you "protect" from this beautiful movement of merging with the All. The more you hold in reserve, the greater the problems will be, and the more fear, pain, and conflict must exist in your life. The irony is that you believe exactly the opposite. You believe that you are safe only when you hold yourself separate, suspicious, and stiff. The truth is that by total surrender to God you not only find true safety and security; you also become capable of surrendering to others if and when this is indicated and furthering for your life. Only when the total surrender to God exists is your channel clear enough to recognize truth from falsehood, to see who should and who should not be trusted and followed. You can shed yourself in safety, as your soul demands, without danger of losing yourself. Or perhaps I can state it differently: only when you can lose yourself can you find a more complete and real you.

The ability to give yourself over, to lose yourself, is an important key to being a healthy and whole person. The process as to how to go about it is the following: First you must mentally fully comprehend the importance so that you will be motivated to set the process in further motion. Next you must make the decision on the voluntary level. It is not difficult to see how you quite consciously and deliberately deny this movement. This conscious decision and deliberate letting go of self and giving over will first seem frightening; but after you have taken the courage to do it again and again, you will discover the great safety and security that arises from it.

Then you will have to deal with involuntary levels that hold back this movement, even though your conscious self may not agree at all with this part of you. You may first recognize the existence of this aspect only indirectly, by manifestations rather than by direct awareness. It requires the usual honesty in self-search and stamina to explore some of the less pleasant manifestations until you recognize the hard core that withholds and denies. This part of you needs to be approached somewhat differently than the conscious part. The conscious part can correspond directly to your will direction. But the involuntary, hidden part does not respond directly to your will. What you need to do is ask the Christ within to make this change possible. Pray for that part of yourself that does not directly respond to your positive intentionality and your good will. Be fervent on the conscious level in your desire to unify all of you in every respect; and to totally giving over to the Creator; and to an ability to yield to other human beings. But realize that this part of you must at first lag behind, as it were. It cannot immediately respond. It often stubbornly holds on, even though your conscious mind may not wish to do so. You need patience and perseverance and trust in the Lord's ability to affect any change for the good that you do not obstruct. Make room for a process within the greater process, in which a corner of your hidden soul catches up with the rest of you which is in a slower motion.

You have no idea about the strength of your own spirit. You constantly underestimate it and believe yourself to be much weaker and much more ineffectual than you actually are. Since you must experience according to your belief, it is difficult to find out how strong you really are. You can create anything, for you contain all divine creative tools. And of course you do exactly that. Some of your creations are, as we know, undesirable, springing from negative beliefs and distorted notions. If only you could see the immense power that lies in your thoughts, in your beliefs, in your attitudes, in your desires.

The power of your own living spirit still needs to be discovered. There is a block to this discovery. You often wallow in the notion that you are helpless and you consider yourself beaten by adversity. Even the popular belief in God can contribute to the notion that you are helpless. Again

it is not contradictory to say that all the power is with God. He is the source of everything. On the other hand, this by no means excludes the fact that you are powerful in your potentiality to unite with this power; to allow this power to flow through you; to be receptive to it; and then to become an active agent of this power. You are indeed a sort of relay station of creative forces if only you know this and used it wisely.

The block exists because on the one hand, self-will of the small, limited mind is so often contradictory to divine will and law. And when the insistence on self-will is great, you actually become less powerful. Your creative forces are paralyzed. On the other hand there is this part in you in which you do not wish to be a fully grown, self-creating entity. You wish to be given to and to not have the responsibility for your life creation. This, too, weakens you in a different way. But both these kinds of weaknesses are not inherent. They are unnecessary and artificially constructed by a false attitude and by ignorance. Once you awaken to your inherent possibilities to create, to change, to effect your own soul substance, other people and your surroundings; you will know who you really are.

This awareness contains, among many other unifications of duality, the specific duality I discussed in this lecture: surrender and standing firm, yielding and self-assertion, giving in and fighting -- for the good cause of truth.

As you grope for the fine line when and how to express both these aspects of life, you will find that they are not two mutually exclusive dualities. Not only is it true that both attitudes are necessary ingredients of life, but you will also experience that the ability to fully give over strengthens you to fight for and in truth. Conversely, the courage to fight for and in truth -- objectively and disregarding self-interest and hidden agendas -- will give you sufficient strength to be able to risk letting go and shedding all of yourself in whatever situation this attitude calls for. You will create a harmonious, automatic response that will be adequate and right, according to the situation. But it requires a great deal of deliberate awareness and groping, trying, growing into this state; until your responses can readjust themselves to their natural destiny, the way they were originally meant to function.

Surrender amounts to a certain kind of inner, involuntary relaxation. The involuntary process comes about gradually as a result of much voluntary work on the outer level. It seems to just happen. There is a phenomenon that some of you may know about and that may serve as a helpful illustration. When people go through extreme states of pain, there comes a point when it is no longer bearable. The fight against pain is being given up on the involuntary level. A total state of surrender to the pain -- transcending the conscious, volitional mind and will -- gives over. In that moment all pain ceases and transforms into ecstasy. This phenomenon is known to the devilish practitioners who commit torture on human beings for political or other power reasons. When they see this happen, they stop their torture in order to get the victim back into a more normal state in which he begins all over again to resist surrender. The point here is to show the transcendent nature of everything if the concept of surrender is properly understood and incorporated into the soul.

For the moment, just take in these thoughts and give them space and scope in your mind, my beloved friends. This will start a new process in which you enrich your personality into new ways of self-expression where there is room for firmness and standing in self-affirmation and room for the ability to surrender whenever and wherever this is an appropriate and fruitful attitude. Surrender to

God is always appropriate and fruitful. Surrender to a leader; a teacher; a helper; a mate; all of yourself and your feelings and certain conditions is often a necessary movement without which you cannot complete yourself.

My dearest, most beloved friends, you are all so blessed, so richly held in God's hands. Know the strength of your spirit as a result of knowing your connection with the Ultimate Source of All.

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